

**A** It is likely that your UPS has a problem and you should try running your computer directly on the mains to see if it works flawlessly. 1 GB of memory is a bare minimum for Vista to run. 2 GB is highly recommended for Vista, so add in more RAM.

### Graphics Card

**Q** I recently purchased an NVIDIA XFX 8600GT graphics card (512 MB DDR2). Due to my busy schedule, I could not do much research before buying. Later on, I came to know that 256 MB graphics card with DDR3 is much better instead of 512 MB with DDR2.

One of my friends wants to purchase a graphics card very soon. Which one should I suggest?

My PC configuration is as follows: Intel D101GC motherboard, 1.5 GB Memory, 17-inch TFT Samsung monitor, Pentium 4, 2.66 GHz.

I'm very much satisfied with the performance of my PC and graphics card, but I still want to know what exactly is the difference, when buying a 512 MB graphics card with DDR2 over 256 MB graphics card with DDR3. Please reply as soon as possible.

**Wamiq Maqbool**

**A** 512 MB or 1 GB of graphics card memory does not do a lot for a low- or mid-ranged graphics card. The big difference in these memory standards is the bandwidth they offer, but that alone shouldn't be a deciding factor for purchasing a graphics card. DDR3 RAM on graphics cards is preferred, though on your PC, the graphics card is already the fastest component. Unless you upgrade to a better CPU and motherboard, you need not worry about DDR2 / . For those running 3D applications (3ds Max/Blender), more RAM is preferred.

### Upgrade Issues

**Q** I'm using an LG MyPC, which has an Intel Pentium 4 processor, 2.0 GHz, Intel 845G motherboard, 248 MB of RAM, 40 GB hard disk and Windows XP SP2 running on it. I want to know if there is any good NVIDIA graphics card for my motherboard. Also, if I want to upgrade my PC with an NVIDIA motherboard and graphic card to play the latest games, how much will it cost? My budget is around Rs 10,000 to 12,000. Help me please.

**Ankit Sinha**